26.2.3 Formatting messages and capturing parameter values

Whenever you create a log entry, you must provide a message. This can be any string you like, but as you saw in listing 26.2, you can also include placeholders indicated by braces, `{}`, in the message string:

```
_log.LogInformation("Loaded {RecipeCount} recipes", Recipes.Count);
```

Including a placeholder and a parameter value in your log message effectively creates a key-value pair, which some logging providers can store as additional information associated with the log. The previous log message would assign the value of `Recipes.Count` to a key, `RecipeCount`, and the log message itself is generated by replacing the placeholder with the parameter value, to give the following (where `Recipes.Count=3`):

```
"Loaded 3 recipes"
```

You can include multiple placeholders in a log message, and they're associated with the additional parameters passed to the log method. The order of the placeholders in the format string must match the order of the parameters you provide.

WARNING You must pass at least as many parameters to the log method as there are placeholders in the message. If you don't pass enough parameters, you'll get an exception at runtime.

For example, the log message

```
_log.LogInformation("User {UserId} loaded recipe {RecipeId}", 123, 456)
```